



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

CONSTRUCTION RECEIVABLES RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering past-due B2B receivables — on pure
contingency

Prepared for **ESS Companies** · July 2026

A recovery partner for the accounts that stopped paying

To the leadership and finance team at ESS Companies — as an employee-owned heavy-civil builder, every dollar tied up in a disputed pay application, withheld retainage, or a closed-out job an owner or GC hasn't settled is working capital your employee-owners have already earned. A documented construction receivable recovers best while the project is fresh and the paper is clean — which is exactly where a firm, professional third-party demand does what internal follow-up can't.

A past-due construction balance isn't a write-off — it's working capital your employee-owners earned in the field. An owner, GC or developer that's still building has revenue and a reputation to protect, which is what makes the balance collectible while the job and its paper are fresh.

Southwest Recovery Services is a commercial, B2B-focused collection agency working business receivables on **pure contingency since 2004**, with recovery reach across all 50 states. You place accounts through a secure portal — contract, pay apps, change orders and the communication trail — and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

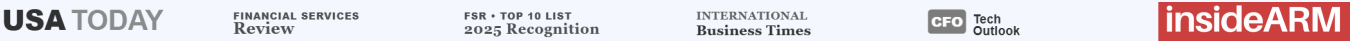
Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A documented, professional process behind \$975M+ in placements — the leverage of a third-party demand your own team can’t replicate.

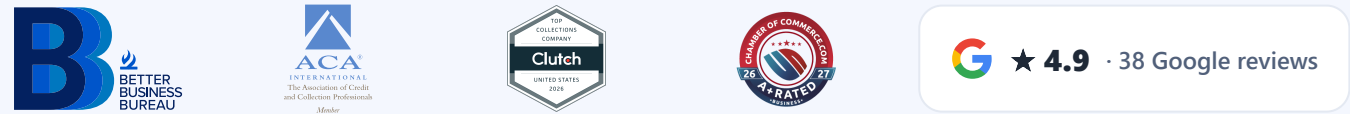
2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

- Commercial & B2B collections since 2004
- Nationwide — all 50 states
- 12 offices across 7 states
- Skip tracing on businesses & principals
- Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY



ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The questions a finance team asks — answered

How the fee works, what happens if a debtor disputes or goes silent, and how to hand it over.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. How does the fee work?	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we recover. Commercial contingency scales with the age, balance and volume of your placements; we quote once we see a representative sample.
2. The debtor stopped responding — now what?	The core of what we do: persistent multi-channel outreach, commercial skip tracing to confirm the operating entity and its principals, and a formal third-party demand on agency letterhead — which alone resolves a meaningful share of silent accounts.
3. What if they claim a dispute?	A dispute pauses recovery — it doesn't end it. We validate the account against the paper: the agreement / PO / invoices and the communication trail. A documented B2B balance usually settles a genuine dispute from a stall quickly. Investigation typically adds 30–60 days.
4. How do we hand it over?	Fast and low-lift. Place the account through our secure portal with the invoices and agreement attached; we map your fields, no re-keying. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement, and you track every step 24/7.
5. Will this reflect on our brand?	It has to — it's your name attached to the recovery. Every account is worked inside an FDCPA / Reg F-disciplined process: firm and effective, never threats or misrepresentation. That protects the relationship and your reputation.

**THE SWRS CLIENT
PORTAL**

Documented placement and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your account documentation and give your team live, self-service visibility throughout recovery.

DOCUMENTED PLACEMENT

Upload the account with its agreement, invoices and statements — we map your fields, no re-keying.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live view your team can check any time.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send the agreement, invoices and communication trail safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves disputes fast.

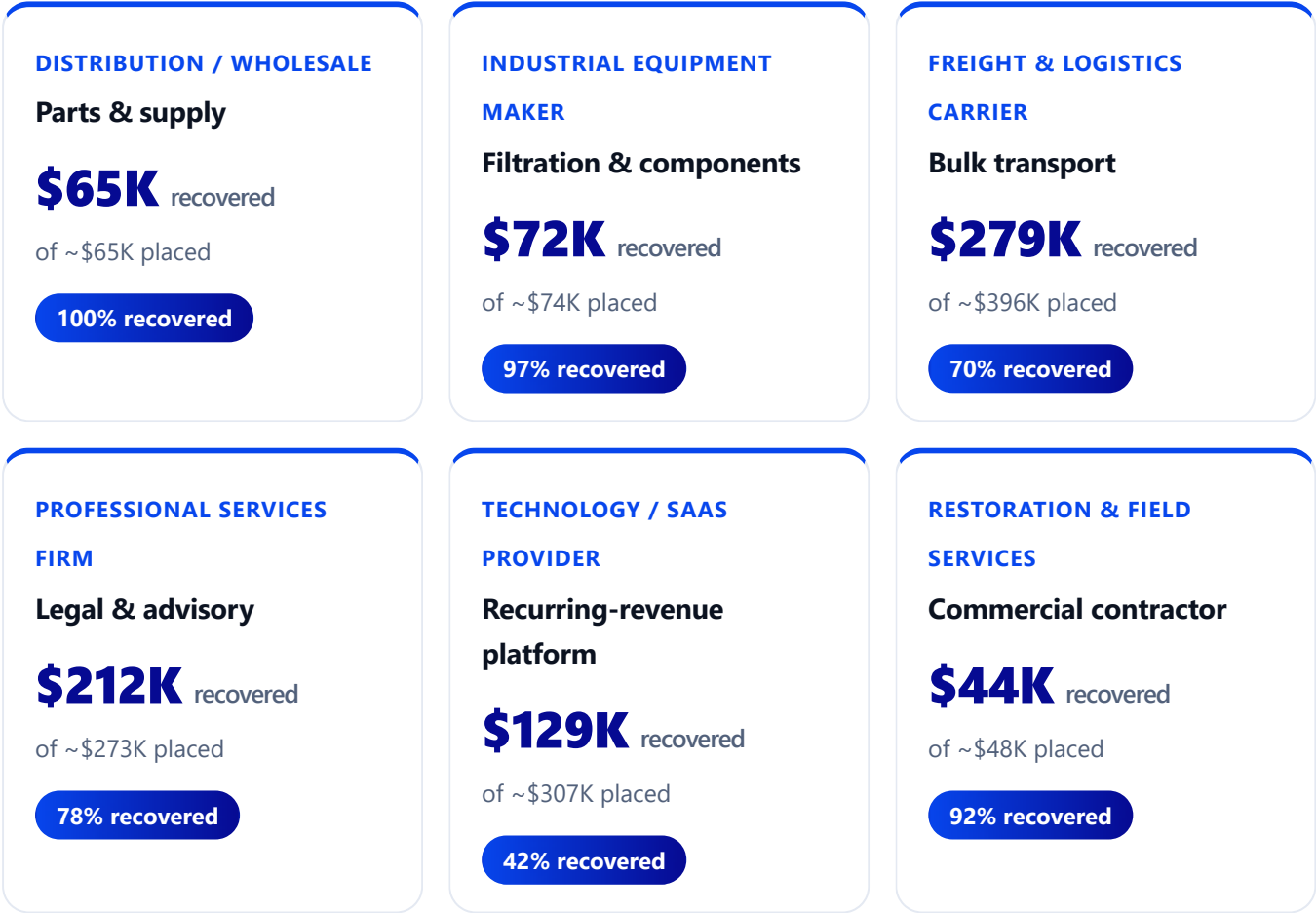
DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log any payment the debtor makes directly to you, so the balance stays accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Commercial Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery’s commercial book, anonymized by sector.



Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery’s book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE DSO ADVANTAGE

Why fresh commercial balances recover best

A commercial balance is most collectible while it's fresh; every month it ages, contact data goes stale and leverage erodes. Research from the Commercial Collection Agencies of America puts collectability at **under 25% once a balance passes a year old**. The highest-leverage move isn't chasing harder — it's placing sooner.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh accounts (under ~90–120 days past due) often resolve in 30–60 days; balances that sit a year collect a fraction of that.

STILL OPERATING = LEVERAGE

A debtor that's still in business has revenue, banking relationships and a reputation — the pressure points that turn a silent account into a paid one.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on the account before it's worked.

05 — BUILT FOR COMMERCIAL B2B RECOVERY

We speak your ledger

A B2B trade balance has its own recovery profile — a business debtor, documentation that decides disputes, and a relationship worth protecting. Our playbook is built for exactly that.



Non-responsive business debtors

Commercial skip tracing on the entity and its principals, plus persistent multi-channel demand for a customer that's gone silent.



Disputed & contested invoices

Documentation-driven validation — agreements, POs, invoices, the trail — that separates a genuine dispute from a stall tactic.



Every commercial balance type

Trade invoices, service balances, freight and equipment — one partner, one portal.



Brand-safe by design

FDCPA / Reg F guardrails inside every step — firm recovery that never puts your reputation at risk.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer,
Southwest Recovery Services

A past-due customer today can be a business you cross paths with tomorrow. Firm recovery that stays professional protects the relationship, your brand, and you from the liability sloppy collections create.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for ESS Companies

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The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Placement-File Standard

The paperwork that maximizes recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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09 — NEXT STEP

Let's turn your aging receivables back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk your past-due file, confirm the documentation handoff, and put our contingency read against a still-collectible balance.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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